

we've already set the hard drive. It should appear in the dropdown. If you haven't created a virtual disk or if you want to create a different one for this operating system, click on Create new hard disk. Proceed to complete the virtual machine creation process.

At any time, to get focus into the virtual machine window, click on the virtual machine window. To get out of it back to the local desktop, press the right [Ctrl] key.

Installing the operating system

Installing the operating system on the virtual machine is the next step. There are two main ways of installing the operating system. One can be using a disk image. This is fine for Linux distributions that are download as disc images. For operating systems such as Windows, you can also install directly from the disk.

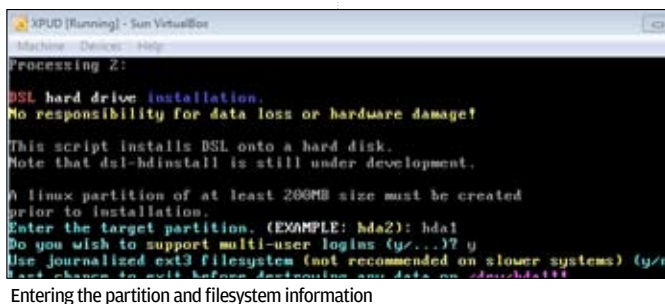
Right-click on your virtual machine and click on Settings. Now click on CD/DVD-ROM from the left pane. Click on Mount CD/DVD drive if you want to install from the CD or DVD. Choose ISO Image file if have a disc image. Click on the icon next to the dropdown to choose the image you want to use.

Here, click on Add. Browse and choose the image. Click OK and return to the main Virtualbox window when you are done.

In our case, we'll be installing Damn Small Linux on a portable hard drive using a disk image from the hard drive.

Powering up and installing the OS

Click the Start button to begin booting the virtual machine.



Follow the entire process for installing the operating system like you normally would with a regular PC.

We will be installing Damn Small Linux (DSL) on the virtual machine, so we'll type install at the prompt when the disk boots. In the case of Windows, you'll be prompted to press a key to boot into the installation disc.

Installing Damn Small Linux on the virtual machine

When the DSL menu shows up, press 2 choose to install. By default, the location for installing the distribution should be /dev/hda in the case of a Virtualbox install with a single virtual disk set up.

When prompted by the OS to partition the disk or select the installation drive, you'll see the virtual drive we created. Follow the procedure for your OS and format the disk with the file system it requires you to. In our case, we chose ext3.

At the end of the installation, you'll be prompted by most Linux distributions to choose the boot loader to be used - GRUB or LILO. When this ends, the installation of your operating system will be completed.

With Windows, you'll need to reboot a couple of times before the installation is completed. Then, turn off the virtual machine by clicking on Machine > ACPI Shutdown.

Booting up the fresh operating system

When the installation completes, disable the mounted image or CD/DVD by going to the Settings window for the virtual machine. You can also do it by clicking on Devices

Related Resources

Sandboxie
www.sandboxie.com
Virtualbox
www.virtualbox.org
Portable Virtualbox
www.vbox.me
Mojopac
www.mojopac.com
Parallels Desktop
www.parallels.com
VMWare
www.vmware.com
Ceedo
www.ceedo.com

> Unmount CD/DVD-ROM.

Now power up the virtual machine again with the CD/DVD drive disabled. Your operating should boot up immediately. When you have it running, you can start using it and installing applications. Like a real desktop, care must



Running Damn Small Linux from within Windows

be taken to shut down the operating system the right way. Files can be corrupted if care isn't taken.

Our installation of Damn Small Linux boots up without any problems with LILO installed. The distribution requires us to create a root password. Once logged in, type startx at the prompt to start X windows. To go into full screen mode, press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F]. Press the same combination of keys to get out of it.

Tweaking the virtual machine and adding components

For slightly better graphics performance, you can increase the video memory for the

virtual machine. This can be set in the General section of the Settings window. Use the slider to increase the video memory. By default, network connectivity is also disabled. To enable it, click the Advanced tab in the same window. Check the network box and click OK. If you click on the Network section of the Settings window, you can have more than one virtual network adapter enabled.

Saving state of a virtual machine

Virtualbox lets you save the state of the operating system. It's similar to the hibernate feature found on Windows. The status of all the programs running are saved. The next time you restore the system, programs continue running from where they left off. This is useful when you're in a hurry and need to turn off the system or when you have lots happening on your desktop and you want to be able to restore from where you left off at a later time.

To save the state, simply click on Machine > Close. Click on Save the machine state. The next time you start this virtual machine, you'll be instantaneously at the position you left it at. It's also a quick way to boot your virtual machine.

When you have everything running as you want it to, you can take this portable drive with Virtualbox in it to a different system and run the Virtualbox application. You'll never

ever have to go around complaining about customizing somebody else's desktop to be comfortable.

These techniques allow you to be completely independent. It's also a good way to backup all your necessary documents along with the software you use on a regular basis. This way, you can access all of it anytime you have a system crash. 

